

With AI, Crypto, Travels, & Larger EVs, what happened to sustainability?

Posted by u/4dxn • 0 points • 6 comments

Microsoft's carbon emissions jumped 30% in one year. New data centers are drawing mega-cities worth of energy.

To satisfy battery demand, we're deep sea mining. Gas is cheaper than ever.

Would our per capita consumption ever go down?

Comments

u/WastingTimesOnReddit • 1 points • 2024-12-05 21:25 UTC

We basically can't reduce emissions very much. People / companies / governments can make small improvements every year but it's like removing a few drops from a bucket. The whole world, every city, all 8+ billion people, everyone uses fossil fuels every day. Global warming is too far gone to stop or reverse it at this point.

Also from a more practical perspective, regular people (low income people) don't have the luxury of paying more to have less impact. People worldwide are living on the edge. Capitalism is great at extracting wealth from people, to the point where they are living on the edge of poverty. Wealth inequality is getting worse. We are fucked and it's only a matter of time. Lots of the hot places around the world will be less and less inhabitable. Like when the wet-bulb temperature is above 110 then sweating doesn't work and humans can't survive outdoors. We have to air condition everything just to survive in hot humid climates. Air conditioning uses power and contributes to more global warming, which means more air conditioning is needed, etc.

u/[deleted] • 1 points • 2024-12-05 21:03 UTC

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u/Identitymatrix • 2 points • 2024-12-05 21:02 UTC

People not giving a fuck about sustainability is what happened. We see that even in day-to-day items. Everyone wants a new car every 5 years, a new phone every 2 years, things like washing machines and fridges barely manage 10 years. Companies don't care anymore about quality because people will still buy nonetheless.

If people used their things for as long as possible we wouldn't have this and we would still have cars of great quality that actually work for decades. We won't have oldtimers 30 years from now.

u/AgentElman • 0 points • 2024-12-05 20:59 UTC

You are picking specific things that are going up. That is not how you find data or trends.

Sustainability is happening because everything in general is being made more sustainable.

u/toldyaso • 2 points • 2024-12-05 20:56 UTC

It probably has to soon, as we're nearing depletion levels of many natural resources.

u/humble_grouch • 1 points • 2024-12-05 20:52 UTC

Likely not